

OFFICE OF THE MAYOR

Diane Veltri Bendekovic,
Mayor

**PLANNING, ZONING &
ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT**

Danny A. Holmes, AICP, Director



CITY COUNCIL

Peter S. Tingom, *President*
Lynn Stoner,
President Pro Tem
Jerry Fadgen
Mark Hyatt
Ron Jacobs

**PLANTATION GATEWAY DEVELOPMENT DISTRICT
ADVISORY BOARD LUNCHEON MEETING**

**Jim Ward Community Center
301 NW 46 Avenue
Plantation, FL 33317**

**Thursday, November 9, 2017
12:00 Noon**

- | | |
|--|---------------------------------|
| 1) Call to Order | Vice-Chair, Jeff Burley |
| 2) Introductions | Jeff Burley |
| 3) Approval of Minutes
June 8, 2017
- <i>Requires Board Approval</i> | Jeff Burley |
| 4) Gateway Financial Report
- August 2017 Financial Report
- Gateway Approved FY 18 Budget | Carlos A. Gonzalez/Dan Holmes |
| 5) Gateway Policing Plan Update | Captain Mark Wendt, Police Dep. |
| 6) NE Quadrant Improvement Project Status | Brett Butler |
| 7) Landscape Changes along SR 7 | Carlos A. Gonzalez |
| 8) Landscape Code Enforcement Update | Dan A. Holmes |
| 9) Gateway Development Update | Carlos A. Gonzalez/Dan Holmes |
| 10) Other: Gateway Newsletter
2018 Meeting Calendar | Carlos A. Gonzalez |
| 11) Adjournment | |

Minutes of the Regular Meeting of the
Plantation Gateway Advisory Board
City of Plantation, Florida,
November 9, 2017

Members Present:

Kevin Bingham
Dwight Brady
Jeff Burley, Vice Chair
Rick Gibbs

Members Absent:

Brian Hodggers
Mike Hooley, Jr., Chair
Davis Pulliken

Also Present:

Brett Butler, Engineering Director
Brittney Freeman, Park Place at Plantation
Henry Wintz, Park Place at Plantation
Captain Mark Wendt, Police
Lieutenant Craig Stalker, Police
Lieutenant Jeffrey Schlegel, Police
Officer Chavez Grant, Police
Reginald White, Code Enforcement Supervisor
Captain Steve Geller, Police
Carlos Gonzalez, Redevelopment Administrator
Horace McHugh, Chief Administrative Officer
Dan Holmes, PZED Director
Councilmember Pete Tingom

The meeting was called to order by Rick Gibbs.

Introductions were done.

Minutes of the June 8, 2017 Board Meeting were approved as presented.

* * * * *

GATEWAY FINANCIAL REPORT

August 2017 Financial Report
Gateway Approved FY 18 Budget

Mr. Gonzalez indicated that the August 31, 2017 report was included; however, the September report will be coming out next week. The September report, which will have been audited, will be provided at the next meeting. About 96% of the tax ad valorem will have been received by September of this year, which are the figures Financial Services usually work with. The next page shows different services provided and charged,

which is in line with what happens every year. The third item from the bottom, Advertising, shows that \$1,800 was spent for Advertisement that goes into the Chamber of Commerce book where Midtown, Downtown Plantation, and the Gateway are advertised. An amount of \$3,500 was shown; however, that is a mistake, which will be cleaned up in the September report. We are still under budget.

* * * * *

GATEWAY POLICING PLAN UPDATE

Captain Mark Wendt provided a brief update and introduced Lieutenant Craig Stalker and Lieutenant Jeffrey Schlegel, who will be midnight Lieutenants. Each of the Lieutenants will have a squad of Officers that will work the area so any issues that come up during the night shift will be relayed directly to them. Over the last few months, issues continue to be burglaries of businesses and vehicles along the corridor. Many are crimes of opportunity such as smashing windows and looking for unlocked vehicles with keys inside at the dealerships. Plantation Inn is an issue that is continually addressed. One of the new license plate recognition trailers on Broward Boulevard just before the Turnpike was mentioned. It is a speed trailer that also captures all tag numbers going westbound on Broward Boulevard, runs those vehicles and registered owners in about 15 seconds of passing the trailer, and alerts the Dispatch Center on any stolen vehicles. Putting this trailer along the State Road 7 corridor is something to explore. Businesses can piggyback the system by installing cameras and tags will be run from any vehicles coming on their property. All data collection is handled by the company so that is one of the big expenses. Costs of the systems vary depending on whether there is internet access and power. It is a great system and allows Police to have a database to go back to if a crime occurs to see what vehicles were in the area. Two systems are being used to see how they work before expanding to businesses. Two Gateway Police vehicles are assigned to the Gateway District and Officer Westbrook and Officer Grant have those cars. In the next month or so there will be two vehicles with Homeless Outreach on the sides. Several officers are being sent to Homeless Outreach training to start addressing the homeless problem in the City, which involves a lot of mental illness and substance abuse. These are specially trained Officers. The problem and cause needs to be addressed to get individuals off the streets. One of the detectives assigned to the County Multi Agency Homeless Task Force is on the Board of Directors and is actively overseeing the program.

In response to Mr. Brady, Captain Wendt stated that the cameras can either be hard wired or wifi. Wifi is the best way to go. The two trailers on Broward Boulevard are operated off air cards but fixed cameras can operate under a hard wire systems.

Mr. Brady mentioned the alleyway between his property and noted that he would not be adverse to installing a camera in that area.

Captain Wendt reiterated that the cameras are license plate recognition cameras. The cameras scan a vehicle as it goes by, transmits it, and immediately runs it through teletype. The cameras are not on all the time so they are not recording while people are walking up and down the alley. Homeowners' Associations can put the cameras at the entrance and capture everything coming in. The School Board is headed this direction in putting the cameras at the schools and Broward County Parks and Recreation are using them. Next Wednesday night, a grant application to install cameras at the Community Center and Dog Park is being presented to the City Council. There have been over 200 vehicle burglaries in the last ten years at those two parks and this will give investigators an opportunity to research what came onto the property and run everything coming into the parks.

Mr. Bingham questioned if something like that were installed on a property if any signage or notification would have to be put up.

Captain Wendt advised that cameras on private property capturing just the vehicles are allowed; they are not recording audio or voice. Signs are a deterrent and not a legal requirement. Different options are available as to places of installation.

A business owner mentioned that he is having a serious problem with noise at Plantation Inn.

Captain Wendt is well aware of what is going on at Plantation Inn and the concerns. That is one of the reasons he asked for the two night Lieutenants.

The business owner stated he had an incident with three Police Officers last week and was told that he could be given a citation for working after 10:00 p.m.

Captain Wendt advised that no citation would be issued; people can work after hours. He will follow up on this incident. Captain Wendt noted there would be an increase in Police Officers.

NOTE: Jeff Burley entered at 12:25 p.m.

* * * * *

NE QUADRANT IMPROVEMENT PROJECTS STATUS

Mr. Butler provided a brief overview of the project. The Engineering Department was charged with the responsibility to design and facilitate construction of the last phase of edge improvements along the northeast quadrant of State Road 7, which is the east side of State Road 7 from Broward Boulevard north to the corridor limits. The project would entail implementing different street lighting and a landscaping edge improvement, both to match what is currently elsewhere along the corridor. This would be the fourth and final stage of a year's long effort to try to implement these improvements for beautifying the corridor. The Engineering Department was instructed to proceed with designing several years ago and the task was completed around January 2014. Subsequent to completing that design, there were some funding issues that needed to be addressed and they had to wait a while before going out to bid, which was done in 2015. A bid award was done at City Council earlier this year and since then they have desperately been trying to move into the contract completion and begin construction, unfortunately, there were hurdles. One hurdle had to do with an agency they were obligated to get approval from, Florida Department of Transportation (FDOT). State Road 7 is a State road and is owned and operated by FDOT; therefore, any work that takes place within that corridor requires approval for permitting. There is a process and every once in a while, FDOT may change criteria that has to be adjusted along the way. Several months ago, it was learned that FDOT had changed their criteria for street lighting, demanding that all street lighting be in the form of LED; therefore, we had to redesign for LED. Most recently, within the last month or so, FDOT developed a project of their own throughout the County, which involves purposely targeting key intersections along various State roads throughout the County. This became difficult to learn in the late stages because a street lighting system for the corridor had already been designed and FDOT came in behind us with their own design, which was affecting our design. A meeting is scheduled with FDOT with the key objectives of learning in better detail what their projects entail and to point out issues of conflict, hoping they will work with us to resolve them. Engineering is doing everything possible

with the hope that FDOT will respond in time and give the approvals and permits needed so this project can begin. We do not want to bind ourselves with a contractor knowing there is not a permit in hand; however, our contractor has been cooperative and is holding his prices. The vendors are also holding their prices so there are no difficulties at this point. Engineering does not want to develop a bad relationship with an agency we continue to work with. Mr. Butler will continue with updates through Mr. Gonzalez and through written news reports.

* * * * *

LANDSCAPE CHANGES ALONG SR7

Mr. Gonzalez advised the City is ready to start cleaning up dead Royal palms and putting in Crepe Myrtles. There is a contract but unfortunately, the contractor is working some place else in Florida due to the hurricane. In November, the contractor will remove all the dead palm trees and then wait a month because the trees needed are not in South Florida; they are available in North Central Florida. The City needs to look at the prices again because they will probably be more expensive than the estimate. This project will be done in two stages; first the clean-up will be done and then the trees will be installed.

Mr. Brady questioned if Royal palms would be considered.

Mr. Gonzalez stated that many Royal palms were damaged during the hurricane. Those trees will be left alone and hopefully will recuperate in time; however, moving forward, the Royal palms will be replaced with Crepe myrtles.

Mr. McHugh indicated that the resistance to the hurricane was not the only factor. The Royal palms were not adapting to the environment and were dying on a regular basis. Other factors were maintenance, potential damage of fronds falling in a pedestrian area, and FDOT said they are no longer approving palms within the corridor.

Mr. Brady questioned how well the Crepe myrtles held up during the hurricane.

Mr. McHugh advised that according to Landscape personnel they did excellent. There are also soil conditions and a number of other factors that are taken into consideration.

Mr. Holmes recently indicated that FDOT is changing their policy with regard to the types of trees they want to allow along the corridor, which also impacts our decision to move forward with the Crepe myrtles.

Mr. Butler stated that the project he described has been handled by FDOT and is in the approval process because of the recent policy changes as to criteria. Roughly 50% of the project involves populating FDOT land with landscaping and because of that they are reviewing it. Design decisions have had to be made because FDOT has taken a more recent policy or criteria position on material and forced Engineering to make another set of revisions.

Mr. Brady questioned if the easements given by the business owners go to FDOT or the City.

Mr. Butler advised that the easements given by business owners are conveyed to the City, not to FDOT. He is not referring to lands that are privately owned but to land that is actually owned by FDOT. The northern part of the corridor on the east side is land FDOT owns outside of the physical constructive boundary of the roadway, it is surplus land.

* * * * *

LANDSCAPE CODE ENFORCEMENT UPDATE

Mr. Holmes indicated that about a year ago Landscape staff addressed the Board. A Landscape Code Enforcement process has been started along the corridor to address some of the landscape issues. This started in the southeast quadrant of State Road 7 and there was a fairly good success with property owners responding to that process. Landscape Code Enforcement is shifting to the southwest quadrant of State Road 7 and will be working their way up the quadrant. Things have slowed over the last few months. Several large development projects have come in, which have utilized a large portion of staff's time. They are still moving along the corridor and addressing the issues.

Ms. Freeman mentioned the replacement of trees lost during the hurricane.

Mr. Holmes commented that the update he was given was with regard to private property owners and that at some point they will be required to address the lost canopy. There is no timeline. Property owners are being asked to get permits and replace the lost landscaping, depending on the amount of damage. The City is trying to work with the property owners.

* * * * *

GATEWAY DEVELOPMENT UPDATE

Mr. Gonzalez provided a brief presentation.

Mr. Holmes stated that most of the time he asks questions about development activity along the corridor. Some people feel the corridor is being neglected; however, there are several projects going on.

- WaWa will be at the corner of Broward Boulevard and State Road 7 on the southwest corner. They are going to City Council for final review and approval.
- Strata was approved. There are 150 units and development is underway.
- Preferred Storage has been approved on the north side of Sunrise Boulevard at 4501 West Sunrise Boulevard.
- Two gas stations, Mobil and Shell, along State Road 7 and NW 47th Terrace, are being redeveloped and both will have new convenience stores.
- Get-Med Urgent Care located at 901 South State Road 7 received Plan Adjustment Committee approval.
- Nuevos Cubanos Restaurant located at 4300 West Broward Boulevard will have primary outdoor seating.
- Nagril Way Caribbean Restaurant is making on-site improvements.

- There has been interest at the parcel located at 400-420 North State Road, which is an existing two-story building with adjacent parking proposed. There was discussion at the pre-development meeting for a print shop and leasing.
- A proposed Burger King located at 931-945 South State Road 7 was discussed at the pre-development meeting. The parcel is currently vacant.
- There has been interest in the DCF parcel. A developer has mentioned bringing multi-family residential with the possibility of retail in front.
- There was interest in a parcel on South State Road 7 and Peters Road, close to the tree farm; however, the developer has requested no information be provided at this time.

A resident questioned if parking meters could be installed along NW 3rd Court, as the swale is a mess.

Mr. Holmes advised that he would have to look at the area to determine the best solution.

A resident mentioned that parking is limited at the Plantation Plaza and the tire shop and noted there is a parking issue on South Hospital Drive.

Mr. Holmes indicated that he would look at the area with Engineering to evaluate the situation.

* * * * *

OTHER:

Gateway Newsletter

Mr. Gonzalez is working on an upcoming issue that should out by the beginning of January 2018. Newsletters will continue to be mailed to business owners in order to save costs. He may reach out to Board members to bring in some articles about any issues they may be dealing with.

2018 Meeting Calendar

Mr. Gonzalez requested the Board review the new calendar and advise of any conflicts with the dates. Meetings will continue quarterly and will be on the second Thursday of the month.

* * * * *

A resident complained about a problem with the Plantation Inn encroaching onto his property without consent.

Mr. Gonzalez clarified that the driveway is on his property but used by the hotel.

Mr. Holmes advised that Mr. Gonzalez is working with the senior planner regarding this issue.

Mr. McHugh indicated that these issues are on individual properties and do not go to this Board.

Mr. Holmes stated that he wants to look at the permits.

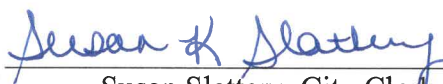
Mr. McHugh advised that they would follow up and give direction.

* * * * *

Meeting adjourned at 1:10 p.m.

RECORD ENTRY:

I HEREBY CERTIFY that the Original of the foregoing document was received by the office of the City Clerk and entered into the Public Record this 8 day of February, 2018



Susan Slattery, City Clerk